In February 2010, IHCL also launched the Taj Cape Town in South Africa. In 2012, it signed a JV with Yunnan Tourism Company Limited 'to engage in development, construction, operation and management of two hotels in Kunming Expo Garden', in the Yunnan province of southwest China. Together, Taj now owned or operated around twenty-five properties in some of the main cities in the world.

In the midst of the expansion spree, in 2012, Ratan launched a 'free two-year hospitality trade training programme for youth from below poverty line (BPL) families'. It gave expression to the fundamental concern of the Tata company to give back to the society what it holds in 'Trusteeship'. Those given training included some of the children of the victims of the 26/11 terror attack in Mumbai. Today many of them are proud employees in various IHCL hotels. By the time Ratan stepped down as chairman, Tata Sons, IHCL had been transformed into a global brand. The revenue of the company had increased by nearly 340 per cent (2003-2013) and the market cap for the same period by nearly 426 per cent.

The steps taken by Ratan have propelled IHCL to gain world recognition and accolades. The institutional structure he established by categorizing hotels led to the various brands making different offerings. It also gave each category the freedom to focus on its targeted clientele and provide specialized services without the fear of disappointing guests who may have entertained incommensurate expectations.

Ratan's acquisition of marquee brands, especially abroad, also gave the group, IHCL and the apogee brand, Taj, greater visibility and recognition and the freedom to provide unmatched service. For instance, The Pierre 'boasts a superb location in Lenox Hill … with sweeping views of Central Park', wrote *The Telegraph*. The Taj, Campton Place, is another example. It has been described as 'the quintessential landmark San Francisco Hotel on Union Square', boasting of the 'City's most revered dining destinations', and its 'outstanding amenities make it San Francisco's ideal home away from home'. In April 2023 IHCL opened its hundredth hotel in Kochi. The branding exercise yielded significant benefits for the group and the company. In 2022, Taj Hotels was adjudged as the 'world's strongest hotels brand with AAA rating', with a 'Brand Strength Index (BSI) score of 88.9' per cent. In India too, it became number one across all brands for the second year in succession. Such recognition would not have been possible if it were not for the meticulous branding exercise that Ratan undertook,